

Onboarding & IT Policy – New Employee Guide

Effective Date: June 1, 2024

Owner: IT Department & People Operations

1. First Day – Equipment and Access Setup

1.1 On Day 1, new employees should report to the IT Service Desk located in Building A, 2nd Floor, between 9:00 AM and 10:00 AM. Bring a government-issued ID (passport, driver's license, or national ID card) for verification.

1.2 IT will issue the following equipment:

- Company laptop (model depends on role – developers receive a MacBook Pro or Dell XPS; other roles receive a standard Dell Latitude or equivalent)

- Laptop charger and docking station (if applicable)

- Company ID badge (required for building access, printing, and cafeteria)

- USB-C to HDMI adapter (if requested)

1.3 After receiving equipment, the employee will log in using the temporary password provided in their welcome email (sent 2 days before start date). The system will force a password change on first login.

1.4 Access to the following core systems will be provisioned automatically within 4 hours of first login:

- Slack (workplace messaging)

- Gmail / Outlook (email)

- Jira (task tracking, for most roles)

- Confluence (documentation)

- HR portal (leave requests, payslips, benefits enrollment)

2. Mandatory Trainings (First 14 Days)

2.1 All new hires must complete the following online training courses within their first 14 calendar days of employment. Each course is available on the company learning management system (LMS) accessible via the HR portal.

- a) Security Awareness Training (1 hour) – Covers phishing, password hygiene, data classification, and reporting incidents. Score at least 80% on the quiz to pass.

- b) Code of Conduct Training (30 minutes) – Reviews ethics, harassment, conflicts of interest, and reporting channels.

- c) Data Privacy Training (1 hour) – Focuses on handling customer PII, GDPR/CCPA basics, and data sharing rules.

- d) Introduction to Company Values (20 minutes) – A high-level overview of mission, vision, and core values.

2.2 Failure to complete all four courses by the end of Day 14 will result in a notification to the employee's manager, and network access may be restricted for the employee until all courses are completed.

2.3 Recurring annual refresher trainings are assigned each January and must be completed within 30 days.

3. Buddy Program

3.1 Every new employee is assigned a “buddy” – an experienced peer (not the manager) who can answer day-to-day questions about processes, tools, and company culture.

3.2 The buddy’s name and contact information are provided in the welcome email. New employees should schedule a 30-minute check-in with their buddy on Day 1 or Day 2.

3.3 The buddy is expected to:

- Introduce the new employee to team members
- Explain team norms (e.g., daily standup time, code review process, documentation standards)
- Point the new employee to useful internal resources
- Be available for quick questions during the first 30 days (no more than 30 minutes per day on average)

3.4 After 30 days, the buddy relationship ends, but the employee remains free to ask colleagues for help as needed.

4. IT Support and Helpdesk

4.1 For any IT issues – including forgotten passwords, software installation requests, network connectivity problems, or hardware malfunctions – employees must log a ticket at helpdesk.company.com. Phone support is also available at extension 1234 (or +1-555-123-4567 from external lines) from 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM local time, Monday through Friday.

4.2 Response times by severity level:

- Critical (system down, cannot work): 1 hour
- High (software not working but workaround exists): 4 hours
- Medium (request for new software, peripheral): 2 business days
- Low (general question, future request): 5 business days

4.3 For after-hours emergencies (e.g., laptop won’t boot and you have a deadline), employees may call the same number and follow the menu to reach the on-call engineer. The on-call engineer will respond within 30 minutes.

5. Offboarding and Return of Equipment

5.1 When an employee resigns or is terminated, they will receive an offboarding checklist from HR. IT equipment must be returned to the IT Service Desk within 5 business days of the last working day.

5.2 The employee must not wipe, reset, or reformat the laptop before returning. IT will perform a secure data wipe after return.

5.3 Failure to return any equipment will result in a deduction from the final paycheck equal to the current market value of the missing item (for employees) or an invoice sent to the contracting agency (for contractors). Additionally, the employee’s access to any personal files stored on the device will be permanently lost, as the Company does not retrieve personal data from unreturned devices.

6. Data Backup and Personal Files

6.1 Employees are responsible for saving all work files to the Company’s network drives (e.g., Shared Drive, OneDrive for Business) or to the designated project folder in Confluence. Files saved only to the local laptop desktop may be lost if the laptop fails or is replaced.

6.2 The Company performs automated backups of network drives every 4 hours, with retention of 90 days. Local laptop backups are not performed.

6.3 Employees may store a reasonable amount of personal files (e.g., photos, personal documents) on the laptop as long as total personal storage is under 5 GB. The Company is not responsible for loss of personal files under any circumstances.